Microsoft Interview Guide

Rounds, Culture, and Preparation Tips

1. Interview Rounds

- Screening: coding + behavioral.
- Loop: 4-5 rounds (coding, system design, culture fit).
- ASK (Aptitude, Skills, Knowledge) manager round at the end.

2. Coding Preparation

- Focus on arrays, strings, linked lists, trees, recursion.
- C#, Java, or Python are all acceptable.
- Write production-quality code: naming, structure, tests.
- Consider edge cases and complexity trade-offs.

3. Microsoft Culture - Growth Mindset

- Emphasize learning from failures and feedback.
- One Microsoft: collaboration across teams.
- Customer obsession and accessibility in design.

4. Behavioral Questions

- Why Microsoft? (research products and mission).
- Tell me about a conflict and how you resolved it.
- Describe a project where you took initiative.

5. System Design

- Design a cloud service, chat application, or distributed cache.
- Know Azure fundamentals: VMs, Blob Storage, Functions, AKS.